

Fragile States Index Analysis

Professional Project Report --- International Humanitarian Organization

Decision-support analysis for identifying where limited humanitarian attention and resources may warrant greater priority.

1. Executive Summary

International humanitarian organizations operate under finite resources and must decide where additional attention, assessment, and potential intervention may be most warranted across many countries.

This project uses **Fragile States Index (FSI) data from 2015--2023** to develop a transparent, multi-dimensional framework for assessing fragility. Rather than relying only on the latest ranking, the analysis combines:

- **Current fragility** --- the latest FSI position.
- **Persistence** --- repeated Alert/Warning conditions across the study period.
- **Long-term change** --- movement between 2015 and 2023.
- **Underlying dimensions** --- the twelve FSI indicators.

The resulting Power BI dashboard moves from global context to country-level assessment, trend analysis, indicator-level investigation, resource prioritization, and strategic decision support.

In 2023, the dataset contained **30 Alert countries, 84 Warning countries, 47 Stable countries, and 18 Sustainable countries**. Using the project's persistence criterion of Alert/Warning status in at least four of the nine years, **122 countries** qualified as persistently high-risk.

The framework is intended as **decision support**, not as an aid-eligibility mechanism or a substitute for detailed humanitarian needs assessment.

2. Humanitarian Context & Analytical Objective

Context

A hypothetical international humanitarian organization has finite resources and cannot provide the same level of attention to every country. It therefore needs an evidence-based way to identify where further humanitarian assessment and strategic attention may be most warranted.

A single-year fragility ranking can miss an important distinction: a country with a high current score may be improving, while another country with a somewhat lower score may have experienced persistent or worsening fragility.

Primary objective

Develop an interactive analytical framework that helps decision-makers:

- understand the global fragility landscape;
- identify countries with elevated current risk;

- identify persistent high-risk conditions;
- distinguish improvement from deterioration;
- identify widespread dimensions of fragility;
- prioritize countries and issues for further assessment.

Analytical questions

1. What does the current global fragility landscape look like?
2. How has fragility changed over time?
3. Which countries show persistent high-risk conditions?
4. Which dimensions of fragility are most widespread?
5. Where do multiple risk signals intersect?

3. Data & Analytical Scope

Attribute Scope

Source Fragile States Index Period 2015--2023 Years 9 Indicators 12 FSI score 0--120 Indicator score 0--10
Standardized country coverage 180 Analytical grain Country × Year

FSI categories

Category FSI score

Alert 90--120 Warning 60--89.9 Stable 30--59.9 Sustainable 0--29.9

Indicators

C1 Security Apparatus; C2 Factionalized Elites; C3 Group Grievance; E1 Economy; E2 Economic Inequality; E3 Human Flight and Brain Drain; P1 State Legitimacy; P2 Public Services; P3 Human Rights; S1 Demographic Pressures; S2 Refugees and IDPs; X1 External Intervention.

4. Analytical Framework

Current fragility

A country is treated as currently high-risk when:

FSI 2023 $\geq$ 60

Persistence

A persistence signal is assigned when a country was classified as **Alert or Warning in at least four of the nine years**.

Long-term change

FSI 2023 – FSI 2015

- Positive = deterioration

- Negative = improvement
- Near zero = broadly stable

Underlying dimensions

An indicator score of **6/10 or higher** is treated as elevated for intervention-focused analysis.

The 6/10 threshold is an analytical choice and is **not an official FSI category**.

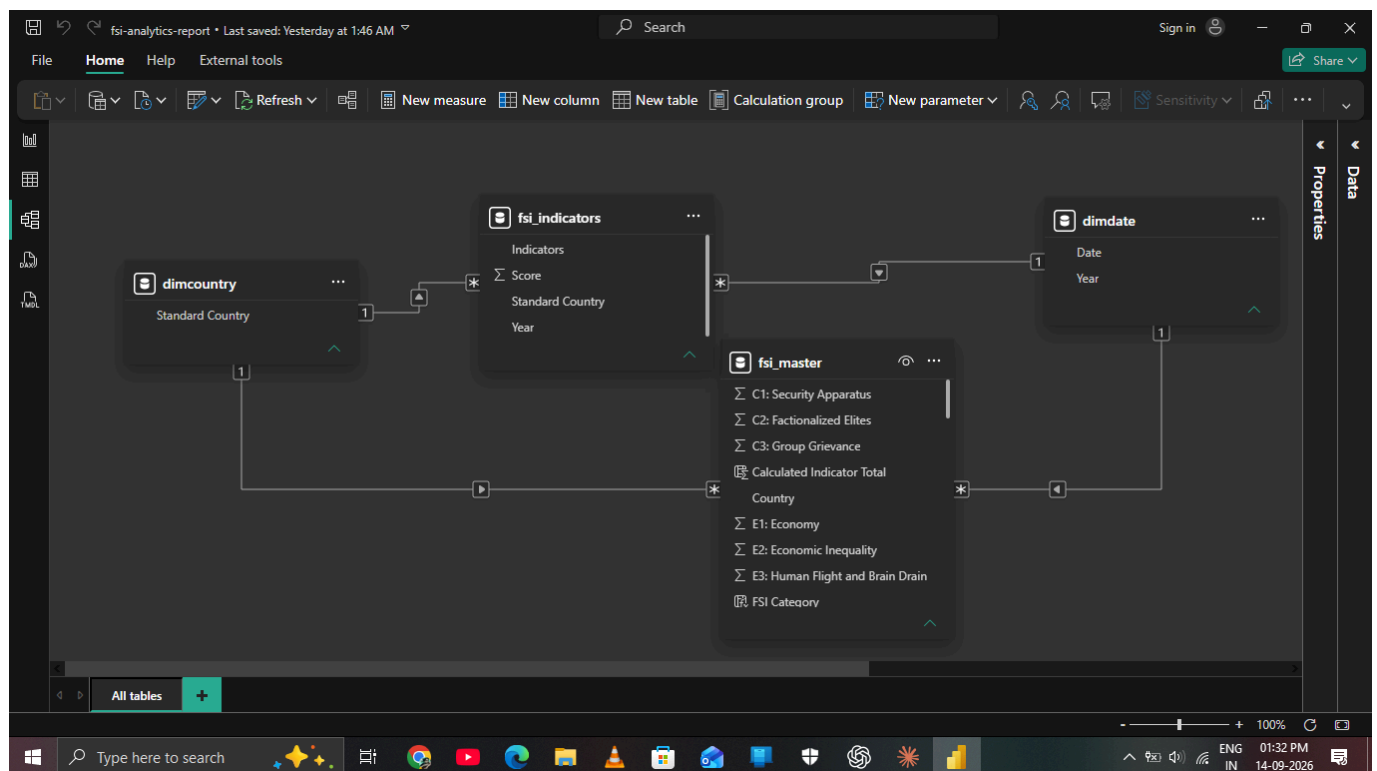
Priority signals

Signal Condition

Current risk FSI 2023 ≥ 60 Persistent risk Alert/Warning in ≥ 4 years Deterioration FSI 2023 – FSI 2015 > 0

Countries can therefore exhibit **0--3 priority signals**.

5. Semantic Model



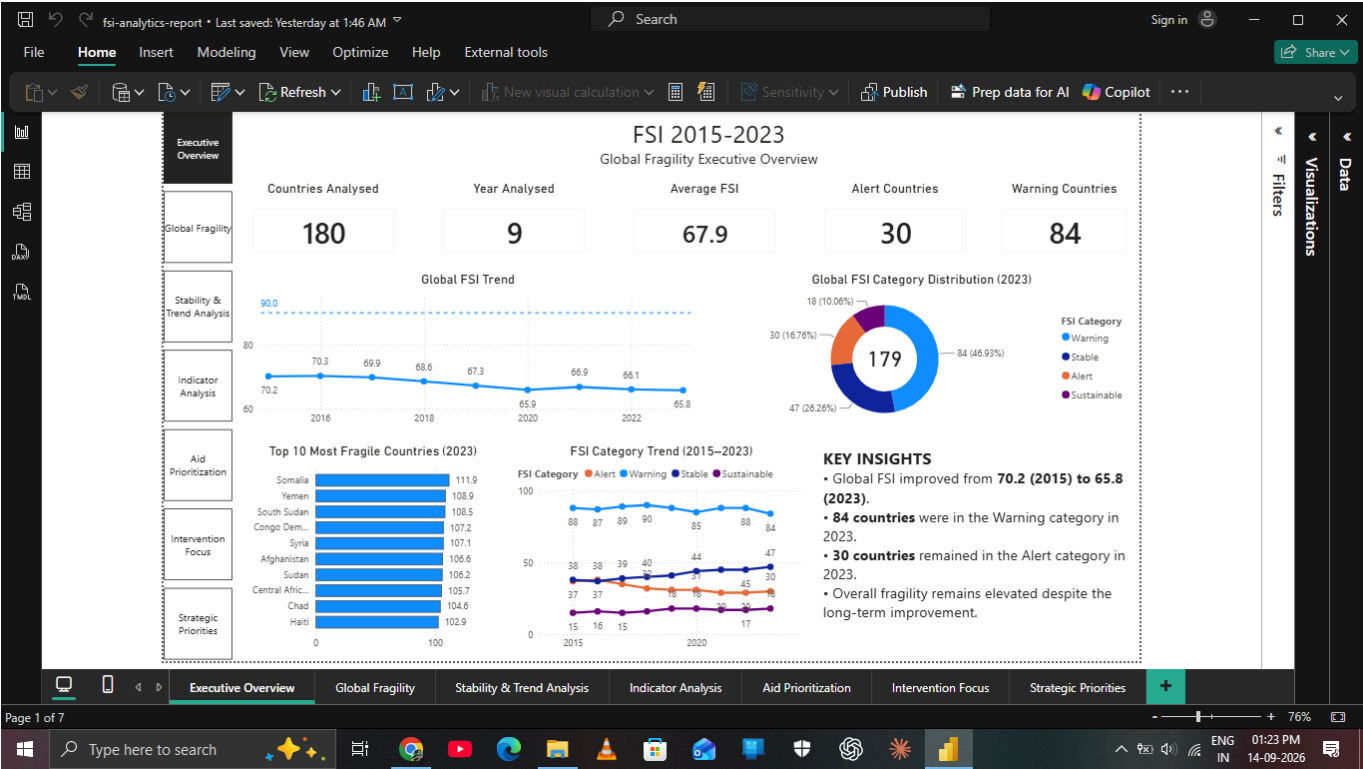
The dimensional model uses shared Country and Year dimensions to filter both the primary FSI dataset and the indicator-level dataset.

- `DimCountry[StandardCountry] 1 → * fsi_master[StandardCountry]`
- `DimDate[Year] 1 → * fsi_master[Year]`
- `DimCountry[StandardCountry] 1 → * fsi_indicators[StandardCountry]`
- `DimDate[Year] 1 → * fsi_indicators[Year]`

This avoids direct fact-to-fact relationships and provides consistent filtering.

6. Dashboard Analysis

6.1 Executive Overview

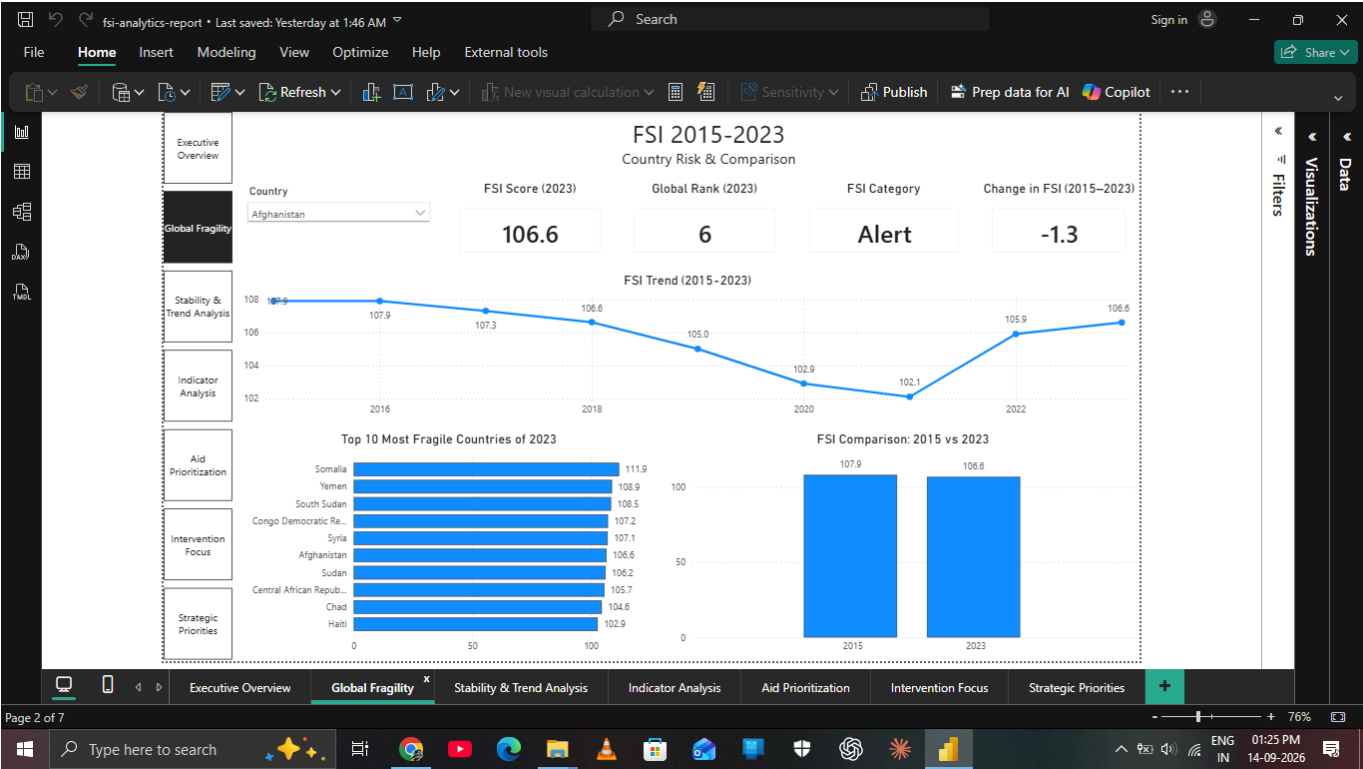


Objective: Establish the global baseline of fragility.

Key questions: How has global FSI changed? What is the current category distribution? Which countries are currently most fragile?

Analytical contribution: Provides the global context required before country-level investigation.

6.2 Country Risk & Comparison

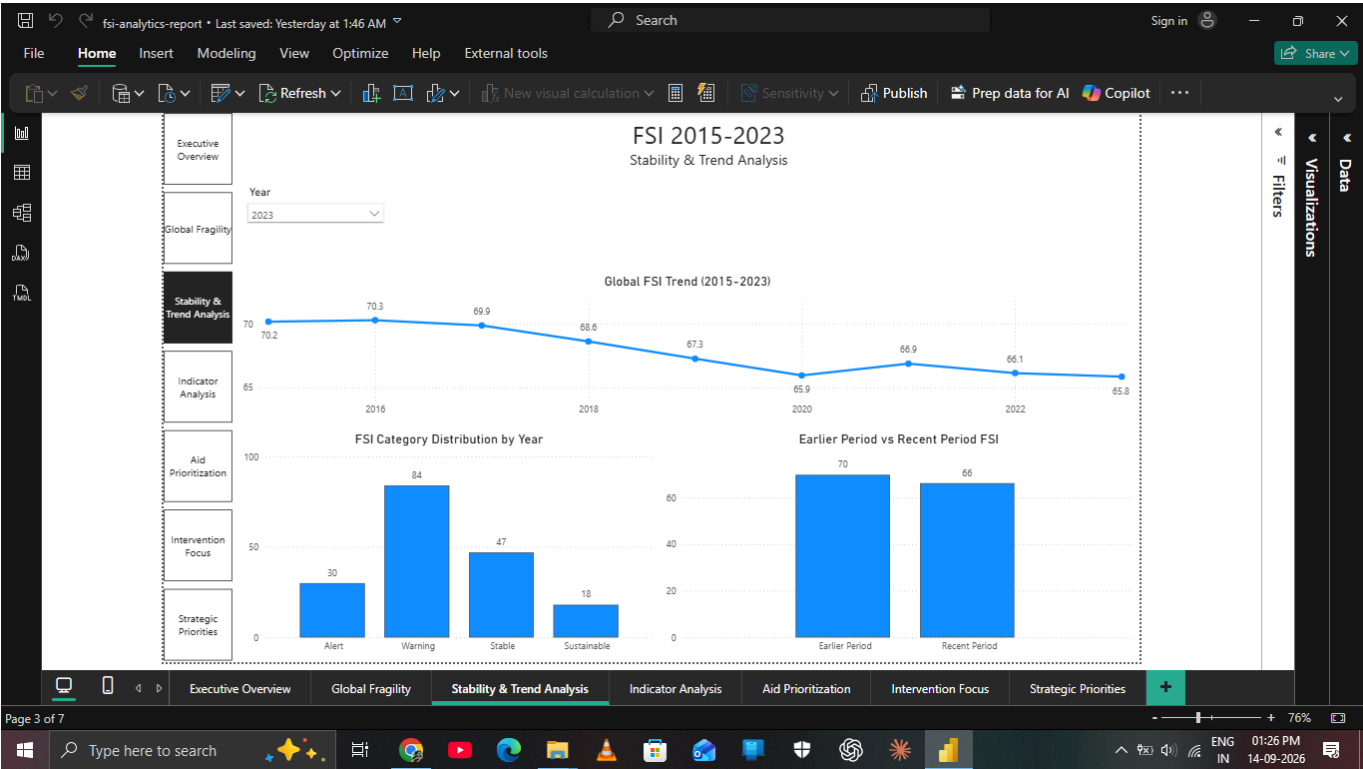


Objective: Assess an individual country's current score, global position, category, and long-term trajectory.

Key questions: What is the country's current risk? What is its rank? Has it improved or deteriorated? How does it compare with the global benchmark?

Analytical contribution: Connects current country risk with historical context.

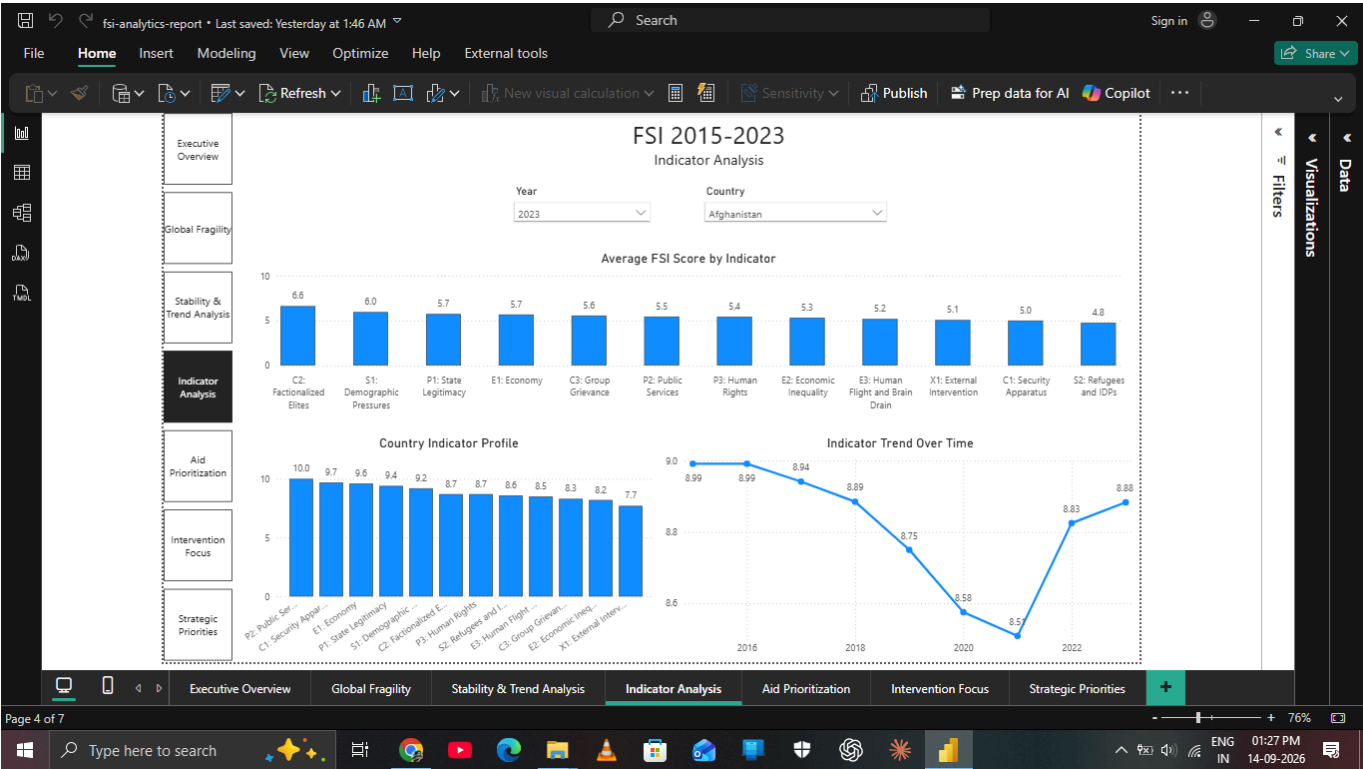
6.3 Stability & Trend Analysis



Objective: Examine global change and the distribution of countries across FSI categories over time.

Analytical contribution: Prevents the analysis from becoming a 2023-only snapshot and provides historical context.

6.4 Indicator Analysis

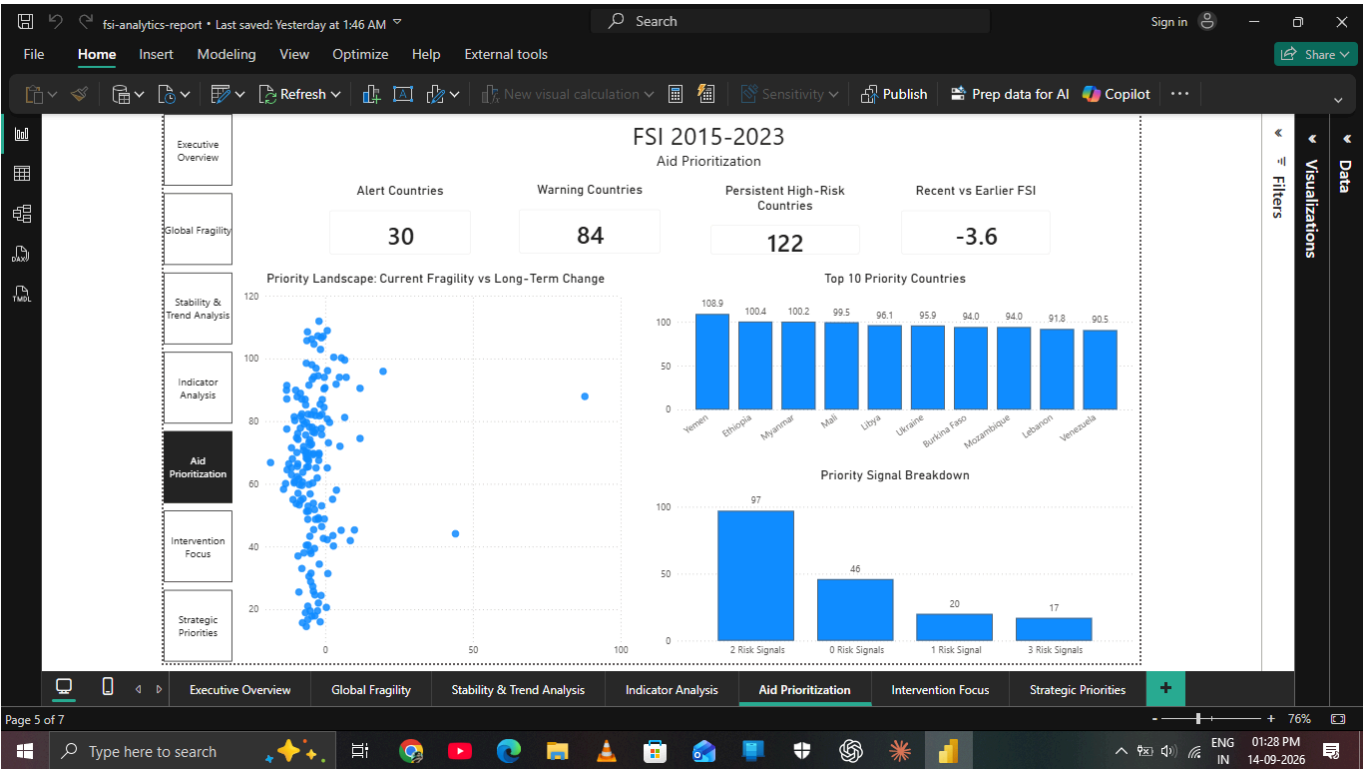


Objective: Move from aggregate FSI scores to the underlying twelve dimensions of fragility.

Visual interaction: Selecting an indicator updates the corresponding historical trend and highlights the related indicator in the country profile. The Year slicer controls current-year analysis while the historical trend can remain independent.

Analytical contribution: Supports more targeted interpretation of the dimensions underlying fragility.

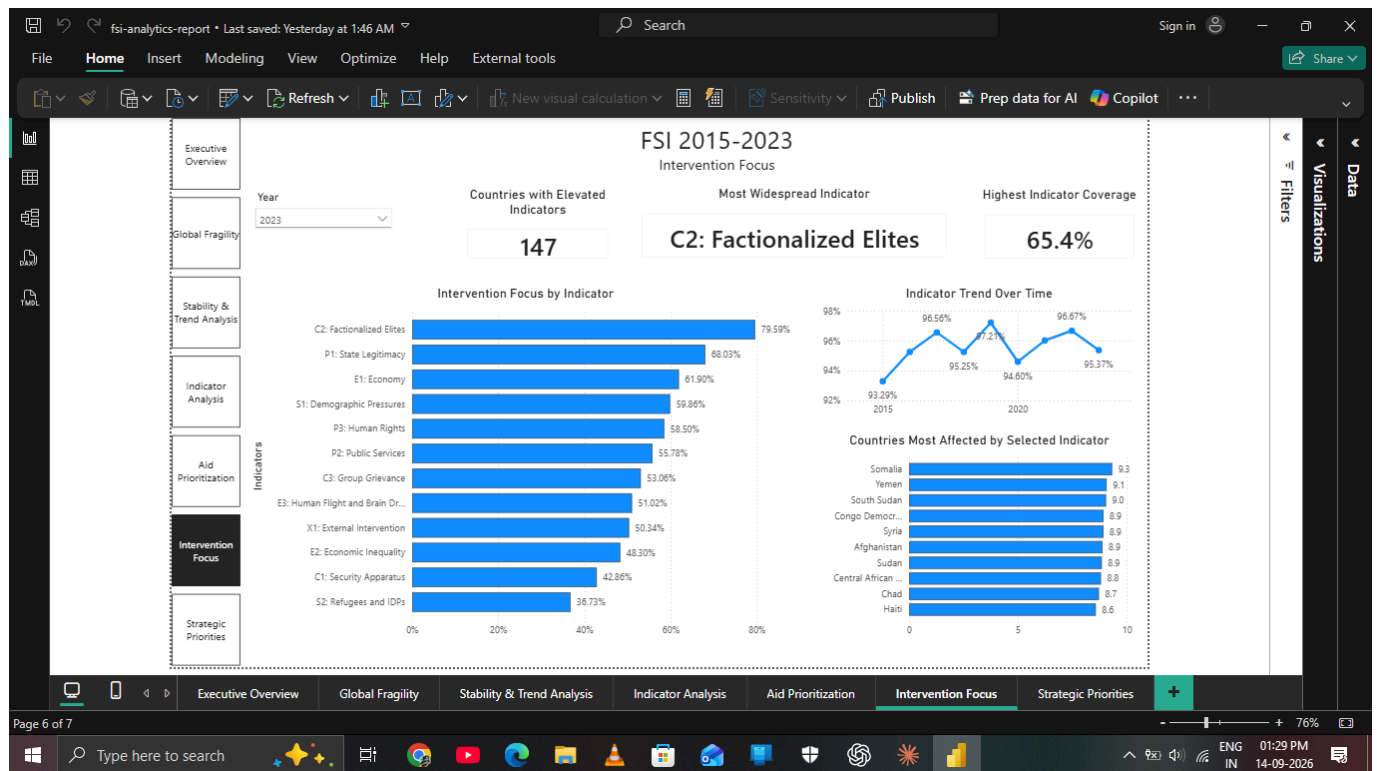
6.5 Aid Prioritization



Objective: Translate current risk, persistence, and long-term change into a transparent prioritization framework.

Analytical contribution: Moves the dashboard from descriptive analysis to decision support without creating an opaque composite score.

6.6 Intervention Focus

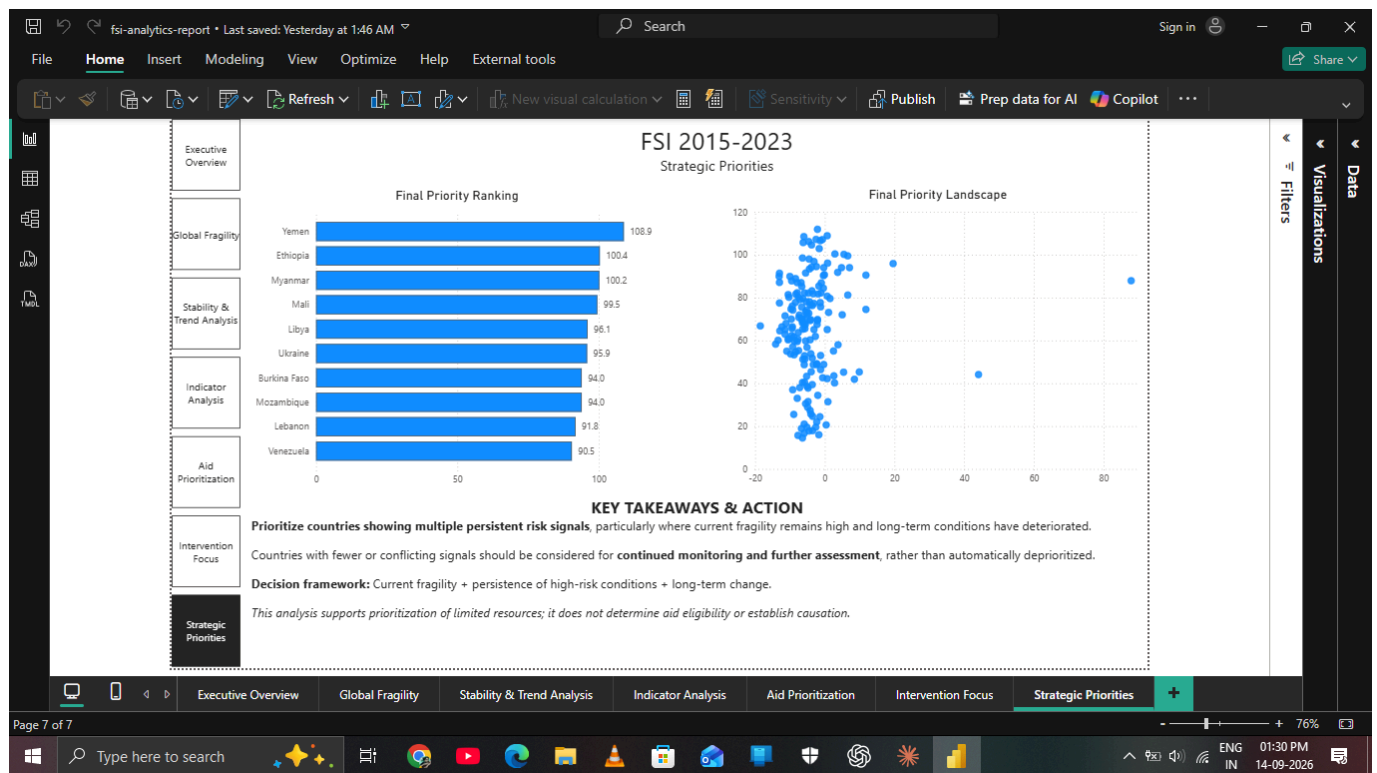


Objective: Identify widespread elevated dimensions of fragility and the countries most affected by a selected dimension.

Visual interaction: Selecting an indicator updates its historical trend and the affected-country ranking. Year controls current-year views while historical context remains available.

Analytical contribution: Shifts the question from **where fragility is concentrated** to **what dimensions are widespread**.

6.7 Strategic Priorities



Objective: Provide the final strategic synthesis.

Prioritize countries showing multiple persistent risk signals, particularly where current fragility remains high and long-term conditions have deteriorated.

Countries with fewer or conflicting signals should be considered for continued monitoring and further assessment rather than automatically deprioritized.

This analysis supports prioritization of limited resources; it does not determine aid eligibility or establish causation.

7. Key Findings

1. Elevated fragility remains widespread

2023 contained **30 Alert** and **84 Warning** countries.

2. Persistent risk extends beyond the current Alert group

122 countries met the project's persistence criterion of Alert/Warning status in at least four of nine years.

3. Recent global fragility is lower than the earlier-period average

Period Average FSI

Earlier period (2015--2018) ~69.75 Recent period (2020--2023) ~66.19 Difference ~-3.6

Lower FSI scores represent lower fragility, so the aggregate recent-period average indicates improvement relative to the earlier period. This does not imply that every country improved.

4. Fragility is multidimensional

Indicator-level analysis shows that different dimensions are elevated across different countries, making aggregate FSI scores insufficient for targeted interpretation.

5. Multiple signals provide a more balanced prioritization lens

A country that is highly fragile but improving should be interpreted differently from one that is highly fragile and deteriorating. The three-signal framework makes that distinction visible.

8. Strategic Implications & Recommended Action

1. **Prioritize multi-signal countries for further assessment.**
2. **Do not rely exclusively on current rankings.**
3. **Pair country prioritization with indicator analysis.**
4. **Maintain monitoring for mixed-signal countries.**
5. **Complement FSI with humanitarian evidence** such as conflict, displacement, food security, health, poverty, demographic vulnerability, and response capacity.

9. Limitations & Responsible Interpretation

- FSI is an index and cannot capture every aspect of humanitarian need.
- A high FSI score does not by itself establish that a country should receive aid.
- The prioritization framework identifies analytical priority, not aid eligibility.
- The persistence threshold of four years is an analytical choice.
- The 6/10 indicator threshold is an analytical choice.
- Long-term association does not establish causation.
- Country/entity definitions can change across years, creating longitudinal comparability challenges.
- Additional operational and humanitarian datasets would be required for real-world resource allocation.

10. Conclusion

The project demonstrates how multi-year fragility data can be transformed into a transparent humanitarian decision-support framework.

The analytical progression is:

Global context → Country risk → Historical trend → Underlying dimensions → Prioritization → Strategic focus

Rather than treating the latest FSI score as the sole measure of need, the framework combines **current fragility, persistence, long-term change, and indicator-level evidence** to identify where further attention may be most warranted.